VTEST BUSINESS ENGLISH · LESSON 3

Reading. Find the Proof.

COACH MODE | EXAM-FEEL MODE

LESSON 1 Orientation ✓ | LESSON 2 Listening ✓ | LESSON 3 Reading | NEXT Writing

01 · READING BRIEFING · 7 MIN

You do not need every word. You need the answer and its proof.

VTest Reading rewards controlled reading: understand the question, skim for the situation, scan for the evidence, eliminate distractors, and move on.

> **Reading rule:** never choose an answer only because it repeats a word from the text. Choose the option that matches the meaning.

SEE THE READING MAP AIDE EN FRANÇAIS

MODULE 02 · READING

Candidate dashboard

Format	**Adaptive**
Texts	**9**
Questions	**12–26**
Time per text	**Up to 5 min**
Today	**Guided → Exam**

NEXT

OFFICIAL READING MAP

CURRENT BUSINESS ENGLISH FORMAT

One task type. Many kinds of evidence.

TEXTS	QUESTIONS	SECTION TIME	EACH TEXT
9	12–26	15–35 min	≤ 5 min
Professional emails, notices, articles and short reports.	The number and difficulty vary with adaptive performance.	Duration varies by proficiency level.	A countdown runs; the test can auto-advance at zero.

Exam behaviour: if you select NEXT with unanswered questions, the real platform warns you. It is better to make the best possible choice than leave an item blank.

02 · THE EVIDENCE METHOD · 10 MIN

PRACTICE 01:30

Question first. Then skim. Then scan.

1 · QUESTION	2 · DIFFERENCE	3 · SKIM	4 · SCAN	5 · VERIFY
What exactly are you looking for?	What changes between A, B and C?	Who? Why? What kind of text?	Find the proof line.	Meaning matches? Choose + move.

INTERNAL NOTICE

Visitor parking

From Monday, visitor parking spaces beside Reception will be unavailable while resurfacing work is completed. Guests

QUESTION-FIRST PRACTICE 90 SEC

What should visitors do from Monday?

A · Park beside Reception

B · Use the east car park and Gate B

should use the east car park and enter through Gate B. Employees may continue using their normal spaces.

C · Use employee parking

START 90-SECOND METHOD

Proof: “Guests should use the east car park and enter through Gate B.” Notice how *visitors* becomes *guests*: the answer may use a synonym.

03 · GIST & PURPOSE · 10 MIN · SUPPORT HIDDEN

GUIDED SET 1

Understand the situation in one sentence.

Before you hunt for details, identify the document type, writer, reader and purpose.

Email · Main purpose A2–B1

From: HR · Subject: Friday onboarding

We are welcoming six new colleagues this Friday. The morning presentation will still begin at 9:00, but the office tour will now take place after lunch because the Facilities team is testing the fire alarm in the morning. Team leaders should meet their new colleagues in Reception at 8:50.

1. What is the main purpose of the email?

A · To cancel the onboarding day

B · To explain a change in the onboarding schedule

C · To ask team leaders to test the alarm

2. What must team leaders do?

A · Meet new colleagues at Reception

B · Lead the fire-alarm test

C · Begin the office tour at 9:00

04 · DETAILS & PROOF · 12 MIN · SUPPORT HIDDEN

GUIDED SET 2

Dates, conditions and exceptions change the answer.

1

Same-word trap

An option copies a text word but changes the meaning.

"free delivery" ≠ "delivery is always free"

2

Exception trap

A rule is true except for one group or situation.

"all staff except contractors..."

3

Time trap

Old, current and future arrangements appear together.

"currently... from 1 May..."

Notice · Conditions and exceptions B1

EXPENSE POLICY UPDATE · Effective 1 November

From 1 November, employees travelling for more than four hours may claim one meal up to €25 without prior approval. Hotel costs above €160 per night still require a manager's approval before booking. The new meal rule does not apply when lunch or dinner is already included in a conference fee. Receipts remain compulsory for every claim over €10.

1. When can an employee claim a meal without prior approval?

A · Whenever a hotel costs less than €160

B · When travel lasts more than four hours and the meal is not already included

C · For every conference day

2. Which expense still needs approval before booking?

A · A €20 meal

B · A hotel room costing €175

C · A €9 taxi receipt

05 · REFERENCE & VOCABULARY IN CONTEXT · 10 MIN · SUPPORT HIDDEN

GUIDED SET 3

Use the sentence around the unknown word.

You may need to understand what *it, they, this change, the latter* refer to, or infer a word from context without translating it.

Short report · Reference words B1–B2

PROJECT STATUS · CRM migration

The migration team completed the customer-data transfer on Monday. It took two hours longer than planned because several legacy records had to be cleaned manually. This delay did not affect the sales team, which continued using the old system until Tuesday evening. The new platform is now live, and initial user feedback has been positive.

1. What does “This delay” refer to?

A · The positive user feedback

B · The extra time needed for the data transfer

C · The sales team using the old system

2. What does “legacy records” most likely mean here?

A · Older data from the previous system

B · New customer feedback

C · Records created after Tuesday

06 · INFERENCE, TONE & PURPOSE · 10 MIN · SUPPORT HIDDEN

GUIDED SET 4

Higher-level questions hide the answer between the lines.

At B2/C1, ask: What is the writer implying? Why was this message written? What is the likely next action?

Manager message · Tone and implication B2

From: Operations Director · Subject: Pilot extension

The first six weeks of the scheduling pilot have reduced overtime in two departments, which is encouraging. However, absence levels have risen slightly in Customer Support, and we do not yet know whether the two changes are connected. I am therefore not ready to recommend a company-wide rollout. Please continue the pilot for another month and collect weekly staffing data so that we can make a better-informed decision.

1. What is the director's attitude toward the pilot?

A · Entirely negative

B · Positive but cautious

C · Ready to expand it immediately

2. Why is more staffing data requested?

A · To prove overtime increased

B · To understand whether the pilot may be linked to absence levels

C · To prepare an immediate national rollout

07 · ADAPTIVE CHALLENGE · 10 MIN · SUPPORT HIDDEN

A2 → B1 → B2/C1

Longer text. Same evidence method.

DO NOT SPEED UP

Harder reading means denser evidence.

When the text becomes more complex, keep the sequence: question → text map → proof → elimination. Do not reread the whole passage for every question.

A2 B1 B2 C1

Report extract · Evaluate evidence B2–C1

QUARTERLY SUPPLIER REVIEW · Executive summary

Delivery punctuality improved from 89% to 94% this quarter, largely because the supplier added a second regional distribution point. Nevertheless, the headline figure masks a continuing problem with urgent orders: only 71% arrived within the agreed priority window. Customer complaints fell overall, but almost half of the remaining complaints concerned urgent deliveries. The procurement team recommends renewing the contract for twelve months rather than three years, with a formal review after six months.

1. Why does the team prefer a twelve-month renewal?

A · Overall delivery performance has collapsed

B · The supplier has refused to add another distribution point

C · Improvement is real, but urgent-order performance still creates risk

2. What does “the headline figure masks” suggest?

A · The overall percentage hides an important weakness

B · The supplier changed the way it calculates punctuality

C · The figure is confidential

08 · FINAL MOCK · 9-TEXT EXAM-FEEL SIMULATION · 28–32 MIN

TEXT TIMER
REVIEW

Read. Prove. Decide. Next.

The Final Mock contains **9 original workplace texts and 15 questions**, inside the official range. Timers vary by level and never exceed five minutes. Exam-feel Mode hides explanations until submission and auto-advances when a timer reaches zero.

Before you start: switch to **EXAM-FEEL MODE**. If one text feels difficult, answer what you can and keep moving.

Reading simulation complete DONE

SIMULATION RESULT

14 / 17 correct

This is a training score, not a VTest CEFR result. Use the breakdown below to decide what to repeat before Writing.

CORRECT	TOTAL	ACCURACY	TEXTS
14	17	82%	9

Text 1 · Q1 · detail
✓ Correct — answer: B · Reception

Text 1 · Q2 · detail
✓ Correct — answer: A · The delivery entrance

Text 2 · Q1 · purpose
✓ Correct — answer: B · To report that one chair is missing

Text 2 · Q2 · detail
✓ Correct — answer: C · When the missing chair can arrive

Text 3 · Q1 · exception
✗ Review — answer: C · No employees

Text 3 · Q2 · reason
✓ Correct — answer: B · The internal course includes company-specific procedures

Text 4 · Q1 · condition

✓ Correct — answer: B · To delay the price increase under a condition

Text 4 · Q2 · next action
✗ Review — answer: C · Wait before making long-term orders

Text 5 · Q1 · gist
✓ Correct — answer: B · Payment problems on older Android devices

Text 5 · Q2 · reason
✓ Correct — answer: A · To include the final troubleshooting information

Text 6 · Q1 · condition
✓ Correct — answer: C · Participants must be available from 10:00 to 16:00

Text 6 · Q2 · inference
✓ Correct — answer: A · A comparison of several trial outcomes with earlier data

Text 7 · Q1 · detail
✓ Correct — answer: B · The price treatment of monthly dashboards

Text 7 · Q2 · inference
✓ Correct — answer: B · It could improve the chances of renewal

Text 8 · Q1 · inference
✗ Review — answer: B · The overall number hides different regional outcomes

Text 9 · Q1 · evaluation
✓ Correct — answer: B · The results did not improve new-customer conversion

Text 9 · Q2 · recommendation
✓ Correct — answer: C · Keeping the tiers for existing customers while testing a different offer for new ones

SUBMIT READING

09 · READING LANGUAGE BANK · 8 MIN

EN · FR · EXAMPLE · AUDIO

Words that tell you how ideas connect.

EVIDENCE | STRUCTURE | LOGIC | BUSINESS

⌕ evidence
▶ AUDIO

preuve / indice

Find evidence in the text before choosing.

✓ confirm
▶ AUDIO

confirmer

The final sentence confirms the new deadline.

≠ contradict
▶ AUDIO

contredire

Option B contradicts the notice.

→ refer to
▶ AUDIO

faire référence à

“This change” refers to the new schedule.

10 · FINAL CENTER

LIVE · SAVED LOCALLY

Your Reading result — and your VTest series so far.

YOUR READING CHECKPOINT

Good foundation — now tighten the proof.

Practice Exam: 9/10 correct (90%). Final Mock: 14/17 correct (82%). Review inference, conditions and exception questions before another timed run.

DOWNLOAD RESULTS

EXPORT SERIES (.JSON)

PRINT / PDF

PRACTICE EXAM SCORE

9/10

90% CORRECT

10/10 answered

FINAL MOCK SCORE

14/17

82% CORRECT

17/17 answered

How scores work: Practice Exam = correct guided answers ÷ all scored practice questions. Final Mock = correct answers ÷ all Final Mock questions. "Answered" is progress only and is never the score.

EXCEPTION · 0/1 correct

NEXT ACTION · 0/1 correct

INFERENCE · 2/3 correct

DETAIL · 4/4 correct

PURPOSE · 1/1 correct

REASON · 2/2 correct

CONDITION · 2/2 correct

GIST · 1/1 correct

EVALUATION · 1/1 correct

RECOMMENDATION · 1/1 correct

VTEST SERIES PROGRESS

Your Final Center

Saved in this browser

LESSON 1 · Course map

Orientation

Complete ✓

Orientation and exam map explored.

LESSON 2 · Module 1

Listening

93%

Final Mock: 13/14 correct

LESSON 3 · Module 2

Reading

82%

Final Mock: 14/17 correct · Practice: 9/10

LESSON 4 · Next

Writing

—

Not completed yet.

AVERAGE OF SUBMITTED SCORED MODULES **88%**

NEXT IN THE SERIES

Lesson 4 · Writing — Build the Sentence. Build the Argument.

The same VTest Practice Lab will continue with the official Business English Writing route: the 9-item scrambled-sentence pre-writing stage, then a workplace essay with preparation, word-count control, guided models and an Exam-feel version.

Format reference: Burlington VTest Business English public candidate information and Candidate's Guide, checked October 2026.

This independent preparation page is not an official Burlington VTest product and uses original practice items.

Official Business English format · Candidate's Guide